



“If rate cuts continue or rates remain paused at lower levels, the reduced opportunity cost of holding gold will sustain its appeal. The trend for the coming year is likely to be bullish”

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Average residential property prices across the top seven cities rose 10-34% in Q1 of 2025 compared to Q1 of 2024, as per ANAROCK. NCR and Bengaluru recorded the highest jump of 34% and 20%, respectively. “Real estate is viewed as a long-term asset class and not a debt investment with linear returns of 6-7% per annum. In blue-chip markets such as South Mumbai, South



“The next sector leaders are likely to be different from those that have led the rally in the last three-five years. Private sector banks, metals and cement may lead over the next three-five years”

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Delhi and Bengaluru, investors can expect an average annual return of 12-15%. High-demand pockets may yield even more,” says Ashwin Chadha, CEO-India, Sotheby’s International Realty.

Chadha says investors can expect 6-8% rental yields in commercial real estate depending on the quality of the asset and its location. Additionally, a gradual annual price appreciation of 3-4%

is typical over the long term. The combination of rental income and capital growth makes commercial property a stable, wealth-building strategy for ‘high net worth’ individuals.

“Going forward, residential demand is expected to grow in a range, particularly in key localities, supported by end-user and investor interest, long-term investment planning and desire for diversification,” says Rastogi.

DIVERSIFICATION IS KEY

Market analysts and industry watchers say one should not keep all their eggs in one basket. The key to survival in this volatile environment is discipline, patience, and selective deployment of capital.

“An investment of ₹10 lakh can be split into 70% equities, 20% debt and 10% gold. In equities, one can invest 20% in large-caps, 30% in mid-caps and the rest 20% in small-caps. Debt (preferably 10-year gilt) can capture the upside due to anticipated rate cuts. Gold will seize the opportunity arising due to global uncertainty. This scenario is suggested keeping in mind high risk tolerance of the investor and an investment horizon of at least 10 years,” says Goel of Bonanza Group.

Agrawal of SBI Securities says the best strategy is to gradually deploy capital in quality businesses and have an investment horizon of more than two years. One should not expect super-normal returns of the FY20-24 period. One can realistically expect decent returns of 12-15% CAGR over the next three years. New investors can buy equity MFs through SIPs. **BT**

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